aseptic-fill, shelf-stable natural form foods, and rehydratable beverages. The packaging system for the Daily Menu food is based on single service, disposable containers. Food items are packaged as individual servings to facilitate in-flight changes and substitutions to preselected menus. Single service containers also eliminate the need for a dishwasher. A modular concept that maintains a constant width dimension is utilized in the package design. This design permits common interface of food packages with restraint mechanisms (stowage compartments, oven, etc.) and other food system hardware such as the meal tray. Five package sizes were designed to accommodate common serving sizes of entrees, salads, soups, and dessert items. Several fresh fruits, bread, and condiments are provided in bulk packages.

- **Safe Haven Food –** The Safe Haven food system is provided to sustain crewmembers for 22 days under emergency operating conditions resulting from an on-board failure. A goal of the system is to utilise a minimal amount of volume and weight. The Safe Haven food system is independent of the daily menu food and will provide at least 2,000 calories daily per person. The Safe Haven food system will be stored at ambient temperatures which range from 60 to 85 degrees Fahrenheit. Therefore, the food must be shelf-stable. Thermostabilized entrees and fruits, intermediate moisture foods, and dehydrated food and beverages are used to meet the shelf-stable requirement. The shelf life of each food item is a minimum of two years.
- **EVA Food –** EVA food consisting of food and drink for 8 hours (500 calories of food and 1 litre of water) will be available for use by a crewmember during each EVA activity. EVA water and food containers is cleaned and refilled with galley subsystems.

Condiments, such as ketchup, mustard and mayonnaise, are provided. Salt and pepper are available but only in a liquid form. This is because astronauts can't sprinkle salt and pepper on their food in space. The salt and pepper would simply float away. There is a danger they could clog air vents, contaminate equipment or get stuck in an astronaut's eyes, mouth or nose.

As on Earth, space food comes in disposable packages. Astronauts must throw their packages away when they are done eating. Some packaging actually prevents food from flying away. The food packaging is designed to be flexible and easier to use, as well as to maximize space when stowing or disposing food containers.

Food evaluations are conducted approximately eight to nine months before the flight. During the food evaluation sessions, the astronaut is given